bear on his analysis of any subject. He had an unusual combination of degrees—a B.Sc. in Mathematics and Physics, an M.A. in English Literature, B.E. in Mechanical Engineering, M.S. in Aeronautical Engineering fol owed by a Ph.D. in Aeronautics and Mathematics from the California Institute of Technology (Caltech) in USA.

Intel ectual debates with him were very stimulating and could always mental y energize me and my team members. I found him ful of optimism and compassion. Although he often judged himself harshly, with no al owances or excuses, he was generous to a fault when it came to others. Prof. Dhawan used to sternly pronounce his judgements and then pardon the contrite guilty parties.

In 1975, ISRO became a government body. An ISRO council was formed consisting of Directors of different work centres and senior officers in the Department of Space (DoS). This provided a symbolic link as wel as a forum for participative management between the DoS which had the Governmental powers and the centres which would execute the jobs. In the traditional parlance of Government departments, ISRO’s centres would have been subordinate units or attached offices, but such words were never